
Sinking Funds Setup Kit

Plan for the “Always Happens” Expenses

Instant Download | Start in 10 minutes

- **Sinking Funds Category List (choose what you need)**
- **Monthly Set-Aside Calculator (how much to save)**
- **Sinking Fund Tracker (by category + goal date)**
- **Payday Contribution Plan (how to fund each paycheck)**
- **Start-Small Plan (if money is tight)**

Quick Start Guide

Sinking funds are mini-savings buckets for expenses that are predictable but not monthly—like car repairs, school costs, holidays, medical copays, and insurance. This kit helps you set categories, choose goals, and save a little each paycheck.

Setup in 5 steps:

1

Pick 5–10 categories you need (start small).

2

Estimate the total you'll need for each category.

3

Choose your target date for each expense.

4

Use the calculator to find your monthly (or payday) amount.

5

Contribute each paycheck and track progress.

Tip: Start with \$5–\$20 per payday. The habit matters more than the amount.

Sinking Funds Category List

Check the categories you want. Add your own.

Category	Notes	Category	Notes
▪ Car repairs		▪ Insurance (6 mo.)	
▪ Medical / Copays			
▪ Home maintenance		▪ Kids / school	
▪ Holidays / gifts			
▪ Travel		▪ Pets	
▪ Clothing			
▪ Subscriptions (annual)		▪ Car taxes / registration	
▪ Other			

Monthly Set-Aside Calculator

Use this to calculate how much to set aside each month (or each payday).

Sinking Fund	Goal Amount	Target Date	Monthly Amount	Payday Amount

Tip: Payday Amount = Monthly Amount ÷ number of paychecks in the month.

Sinking Fund Tracker

Track contributions so you know you're covered before the expense hits.

Fund	Goal	Current	Next Contribution	Notes

Payday Contribution Plan + Start-Small Plan

Use this page if money is tight. Build the habit, then increase later.

My payday contribution plan:

- Paycheck #1: Set aside \$_____ total for sinking funds.
- Paycheck #2: Set aside \$_____ total for sinking funds.
- First category to fund: _____
- Second category to fund: _____

Start-Small Plan (circle one):

- | | | |
|-------------|-----------------|-------------------|
| ▪ Option A: | \$5 per payday | (build the habit) |
| ▪ Option B: | \$10 per payday | (steady progress) |
| ▪ Option C: | \$20 per payday | (faster buffer) |

Reminder: Sinking funds turn surprises into plans.